



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Paul's Community School

School Website: <https://spcsokc.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Paul's Community School (South Oklahoma City, OK) presents a robust classical Christian program, with clear emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Great Books culture, Latin study, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative moments with Socratic dialogue and rhetorical training. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation of character and virtue in a Christian, truth-seeking context, rather than solely information delivery or job preparation. Across six categories, the school demonstrates strong alignment with classical education principles, yielding an overall CLASSICAL designation.

Key strengths across categories include explicit statements of formation toward truth, goodness, and beauty; a Trivium-centered curriculum with emphasis on Great Books and liberal arts; a pedagogy that blends singing, memory work, contemplative practice, and Socratic/seminar style inquiry; and a family-centric community that partners with parents and invites ongoing involvement. The school's own materials repeatedly foreground theological foundations, communal worship or liturgical rhythms, and a vision of education as formation within a Christian frame. These elements are consistently reinforced by multiple public-facing pages (About, Philosophy of Education, Get Involved, Admissions, and specific faculty pages). Citations from the school's public content illustrate these points, including explicit references to the Trivium, Great Books, and Christ-centered mission, as well as the strong parental partnership and open-Door approach to engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a Christ-centered environment and formation in God's image, with content stating that students are "created in the image of the triune God" and that education should enable a life of love toward God and neighbor. - Public pages reference worshipful or liturgical framing (e.g., "Christ-centered environment" and "true, the good, and the beautiful" language) and emphasize a sacred, communal dimension to learning. - Descriptions of education foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as transcendental, knowable ideals, consistent with a theological/metaphysical grounding.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; transcendentals; virtue; theology; liturgy; worship; imago Dei; triune God; Christ; sacred language. The materials explicitly connect schooling to the transcendent and to a theology-based framework. - Negative keywords: None evident (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or secularist schooling markers appearing in the public materials). Positive signal predominates.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present education as formation toward eternal, transcendent ideals within a Christian frame, with explicit references to theology, liturgical/communal life, and sacred aims. This strongly satisfies the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria and aligns with classical expectations.

(score justification derived from public-material wording and lexicon matches; see the Positive keyword indicators in the classicality lexicon for alignment with "truth/goodness/beauty," "theology," "liturgical," and related terms).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on formation toward virtue and wisdom rather than mere job-readiness; the public language uses phrases like “formation,” “virtue,” and “human flourishing,” and explicitly describes education as forming students toward a life of love and virtue grounded in Christian truths. - There is emphasis on the pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as real and knowable, reflecting a teleological aim beyond information transfer. - The “Get Involved” and founding statements tie education to a long tradition aimed at cultivating wisdom and virtue, not solely vocational outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé/contemplation, classical mission, human excellence, soul craft. - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials; there is no emphasis on workforce-centric terms or “21st-century skills” as primary aims.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose centers on human formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, with a classical telos aligned to Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, consistent with classical education norms.

(Positive keyword set aligned with lexicon sections “School Purpose and Goal.” See the lexicon for reference.)

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is described as central: “grammar, dialectic and rhetoric” constitute the core liberal arts of grammar, logic (dialectic), and rhetoric, with the quadrivium (astronomy, music, mathematics, geometry) following as foundational arts. This is explicitly stated in school materials. - A strongly liberal-arts oriented curriculum is described, including Latin, literature, mathematics, science, history, and the arts. The public materials emphasize “great books” and “the best books of a culture” as a core curricular approach and emphasize “the Great Conversation.” - History is framed as a through-line across disciplines (e.g., “History, not social studies,” in some descriptions; and the public materials consistently connect historical study with Western civilization and primary texts). - Great Books / Great Conversation and reading of primary texts are highlighted as curricular anchors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar; dialectic; rhetoric; Great Books; great conversation; primary sources; Latin; history; Western civilization; quadrivium; astronomy; music; mathematics; geometry; Socratic texts. - Negative keywords: There are no explicit signals of “project-based learning dominance” or “STEM-first” framing in the public materials; curriculum language remains classical rather than reformulated into non-classical terms.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly built around the liberal-arts Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books, and classical humanities, with a clear through-line across grades. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for curriculum.

(References to Trivium/Great Books/Latin/etc. are in the public SPCS materials and the philosophy of education PDFs.)

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials note a blend of contemplative/restful pedagogy and rigorous inquiry. The lower grades emphasize singing, memory, and repetition as a means of forming memory and delight. The upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric development. This dual structure is explicitly described (lower-school singing, review; upper-school Socratic/seminar style; rhetoric and oratory opportunities). - The Great-Books/trivium framework informs pedagogy: grammar/dialectic/rhetoric are not just topics but pedagogical methods, with history and other subjects integrated to reflect the Trivium's method. This is described in the philosophy and “About” materials. - There are explicit mentions of memory-work, chanting, and recitation as classical pedagogical tools, aligned with scholé and contemplative learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, oratory, debate, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé, wonder, contemplative/restful learning. - Negative keywords: The lexicon warns against “project-based only” or constructivist models; the SPCS materials show a mixed pedagogy rather than a purely project-based approach, with explicit classical methods. No strong negative signals observed in public content.

Why this rating - The school explicitly describes both contemplative/restful elements and high-utility, rhetoric-based high-school pedagogy, including Socratic dialogue and seminars, matching CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

(Direct references to Socratic seminars and memory-based pedagogy appear in the SPCS content and philosophy materials.)

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are framed as model teachers and mentors who form the living curriculum, with a focus on virtue and expertise. SPCS materials emphasize “Highly Skilled Teachers” and a “portrait of what a teacher should be” within the school culture. The About/Meet the Team content provides examples of faculty and roles, highlighting a community of educators who embody the school’s mission. - The school presents a collaborative, collegial faculty structure and a “faculty as living curriculum” concept, aligning with classical formation of teachers as mentors and exemplars. - Public materials show a formal staff and leadership structure (Head of School and named teachers), demonstrating a stable, prepared faculty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; professional competency; dedication to classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: None evident in public content (no “certification-driven” or purely corporate language that would clash with a classical-faculty ideal).

Why this rating - The public materials frame faculty as integral to the school’s classical formation, not as passive implementers, aligning with the CLASSICAL category.

(References to “Highly Skilled Teachers” and faculty pages are in the Get Involved/Meet the Team sections and staff listings.)

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a strong family partnership and a model where parents are co-teachers and partners in education. Public content states: “Strong Family Partnership” and “value the role of the family and partner with parents and care givers through training events and frequent communication.” - The school actively welcomes parent involvement and provides opportunities for parental formation via the website (book studies, gatherings) and communications; there are explicit parent-facing pages (Admissions, Family information, partnership language). The “Apply” and “Parent Covenant/Family” sections indicate ongoing parent engagement and obligation to partner in education. - Admission information includes parental participation, and financial-aid/tuition pages reflect family engagement in the school community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; training events; open campus; frequent communication; family covenant; welcome for visits. - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials; no consumer-centric or minimal-parent-involvement signals.

Why this rating - The materials portray a robust, ongoing, and reciprocal relationship with families and the community, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parent engagement and community involvement.

Aggregate Assessment

All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the evidence and keyword analysis. The school demonstrates comprehensive alignment with the classical education rubric across religious/metaphysical foundations, pur-

poseful formation of character and wisdom, classical curriculum, traditional pedagogy, model faculty, and engaged parents/community.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category shifted toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete steps to move the needle would include:
- Explicitly codifying and publishing a concise “Great Books” curriculum map by grade level, including primary texts and how they interrelate across disciplines.
- Adding a transparent, shared-language summary of the “Scholé” or contemplative time within daily schedules to demonstrate sustained restfulness as a formal pedagogical practice.
- Providing public-facing examples of student work that showcase high-level Socratic seminars or public speaking (e.g., student speeches, debates, or oratorical exercises) with assessment rubrics.
- Expanding parental-formation resources (e.g., a regular parent book club or liturgical calendar alignment resources) to deepen parent engagement in the classical formation beyond visits and general communications.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.